GUIDE

Schnittkante

Splits scanned sheets into single PDF pages along the red lines. In the web version the PDF is uploaded to your server, cut there, and the ZIP is downloaded from there. The Windows and Linux programs cut on your own computer. No text is read.

Choose the layout first

The very first step is the layout at the top. Choose 4→1, 2→1, 2 (90°)→1, or 1→1 *before* opening the PDF. Switching after the sheet is already on screen does not change the cut.

1. **Choose the layout.** The dark button is the one used when the file opens. On screen it is labelled **Aufteilung**.
2. **Then open the PDF**, with **Andere PDF** or by dropping the file onto the page.
3. **Check the red lines** and drag them if needed. Nothing is cut yet.
4. **Schnitt ausführen** runs the cut. Then save the ZIP.

If the layout was wrong, choose the right one and open the same PDF again. Only that second opening recalculates the lines.

The buttons in the program are in German. This guide uses those labels as they appear on screen.

Web interface on your own server

The browser version needs a computer that stays on the network. The PDF is uploaded to that server. The server cuts it and offers the ZIP for download. The Windows and Linux program files do not need this server: they keep the PDF on your computer.

The server runs the program itself, not just a folder of finished pages. nginx forwards the address to that program.

1. Node.js and the source

1. Install Node.js 22 on the server, from nodejs.org or from the system packages.
2. Get the source from `https://github.com/joergre/Schnittkante` and build it:

```
git clone https://github.com/joergre/Schnittkante.git /opt/schnittkante
cd /opt/schnittkante
npm install
NITRO_PRESET=node-server npm run build
PORT=3000 node .output/server/index.mjs
```

The program then listens on port 3000 and accepts the PDFs.

2. nginx

Create `/etc/nginx/sites-available/schnittkante`. Replace the name after `server_name` with your own address, or with _ if you only use the IP. `client_max_body_size` allows large scans.

```
server {
    listen 80;
    server_name schnittkante.intern;
    client_max_body_size 64m;
    location / {
        proxy_pass http://127.0.0.1:3000;
    }
}
```

```
sudo ln -s /etc/nginx/sites-available/schnittkante /etc/nginx/sites-enabled/schnittkante
sudo nginx -t
sudo systemctl reload nginx
```

Then open `http://schnittkante.intern` or `http://` plus the server IP. Port 80 must be reachable. The PDF is uploaded to this server, cut there, and the ZIP is downloaded from there.

The program on port 3000 has to keep running. After a change to the source, build again with `NITRO_PRESET=node-server npm run build` and start the program again.

Install the web app

The web app is Schnittkante in the browser, without an exe. The address is that of your own server, for example `http://schnittkante.intern`. The PDF is uploaded to the server, cut there, and the ZIP comes back from the server.

Windows and Linux, Chrome or Edge

1. Open the server address.
2. Click the **Install** icon at the right of the address bar. If it is missing: the three-dot menu, then **Install Schnittkante** or **Install app**.
3. Confirm **Install**.
4. Schnittkante is then in the start menu and opens without an address bar, like its own program.

Android, Chrome

1. Open the address in Chrome.
2. Open the three-dot menu.
3. **Install app** or **Add to Home screen**.
4. Confirm. The icon sits with the other apps.

iPhone and iPad, Safari

1. Open the address in Safari. Chrome on the iPhone cannot do this.
2. Tap **Share** at the bottom (square with an arrow).
3. **Add to Home Screen**.
4. **Add**. The icon is on the Home Screen.

Remove it like any other app: hold the icon, then Remove. The address in the browser still works as long as your server is running.

Windows

There are two files. Both are at `https://github.com/joergre/Schnittkante`. Neither is signed. Windows therefore says the computer was protected and calls the publisher unknown. That is normal for a program shared this way. It is not a virus warning from Schnittkante.

Without installation: Schnittkante.exe

1. Put the file in a fixed place, for example `Documents\Schnittkante`. Do not leave it only in Downloads.
2. Double-click.
3. If the blue bar appears: **More info**.
4. Then **Run anyway**.
5. Schnittkante opens. This does not create a Start menu entry.
6. For a desktop icon: right-click the exe, **Send to**, **Desktop (create shortcut)**.

With installation: Schnittkante-Setup.exe

1. Double-click `Schnittkante-Setup.exe`.
2. The same Windows warning: **More info**, then **Run anyway**.
3. The installer asks nothing else. It puts the program in `C:\Users\YourName\AppData\Local\Schnittkante`.
4. A shortcut appears on the desktop and in the Start menu. The program starts by itself at the end.
5. Remove it: **Settings** → **Apps** → **Schnittkante** → **Uninstall**. Or run `Deinstallieren.exe` in the folder above.

Linux

The files are at `https://github.com/joergre/Schnittkante`.

One file: Schnittkante.AppImage

1. Save the file, for example on the desktop or in `~/Applications`.
2. Right-click, **Properties**.
3. Under **Permissions**: tick **Allow executing file as program**.
4. Double-click. If the file manager asks, choose **Run**, not “Display”.
5. If that fails, in a terminal in that folder: `chmod +x Schnittkante.AppImage` and then `./Schnittkante.AppImage`.
6. The file is the program. If it is deleted or moved, a shortcut to it dies. It does not add itself to the application menu.

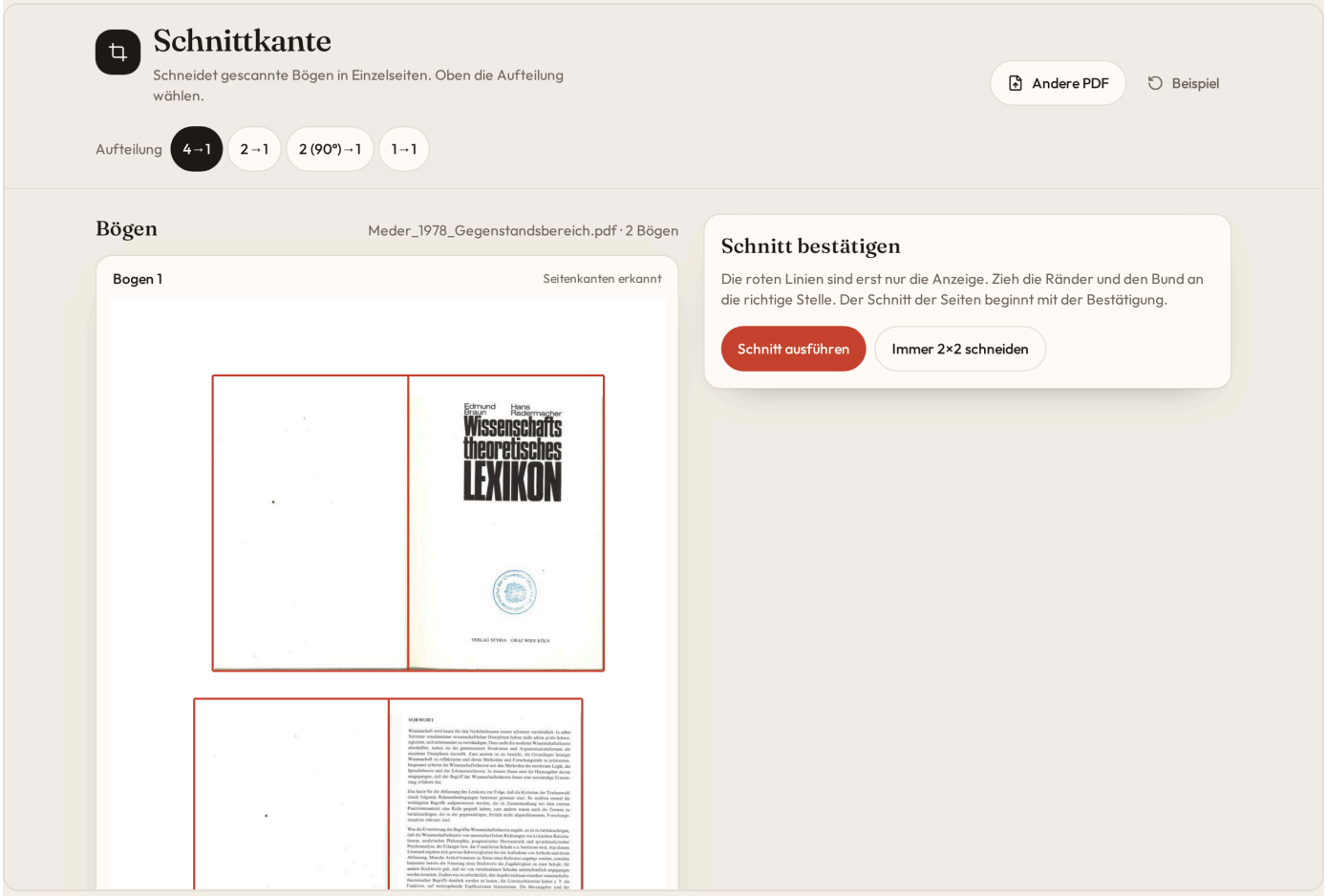
Package: schnittkante.deb

For Ubuntu, Linux Mint, and Debian.

1. Double-click `schnittkante.deb`. The software installer or App Center opens.
2. **Install** and enter the password.
3. **Schnittkante** is then in the application menu.
4. The same step in a terminal, in the folder that holds the file: `sudo apt install ./schnittkante.deb`.
5. Remove it in the software center, or with `sudo apt remove schnittkante`.

SCREEN

What is on the screen



The sheet with the red lines is on the left, the confirmation on the right. Nothing has been cut yet.

Andere PDF

Opens your own file. It replaces the current sheet at once.

Beispiel

Loads the included sample sheet again.

Aufteilung

Choose this before opening the PDF. Once the sheet is there, another button does not change the cut. Choose the right kind, then open the PDF again.

Bögen

Each page of the PDF is one sheet. Under it, the program says how sure it was about the edge.

A PDF can also be dropped onto the page instead of using the button.

LAYOUT

The four ways to cut

The four choices are at the top. They must be selected before the PDF is opened. Switching while a sheet is already loaded has no effect.

4 → 1

Vier Seiten auf einem Bogen, zwei Zeilen.



4→1. Two rows, left and right in each row. One sheet becomes four pages.

2 → 1

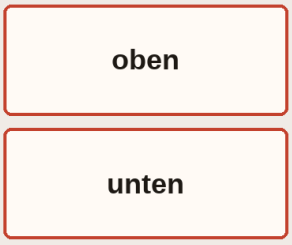
Zwei Seiten nebeneinander, eine Zeile.



2→1. One row, a vertical gutter. One sheet becomes two pages.

2 (90°) → 1

Zwei Seiten übereinander. Jede Seite wird um eine Vierteldrehung aufgestellt.



Danach steht der Text aufrecht.

2 (90°)→1. Two pages one above the other. Each is turned a quarter turn so the text stands upright.

1 → 1

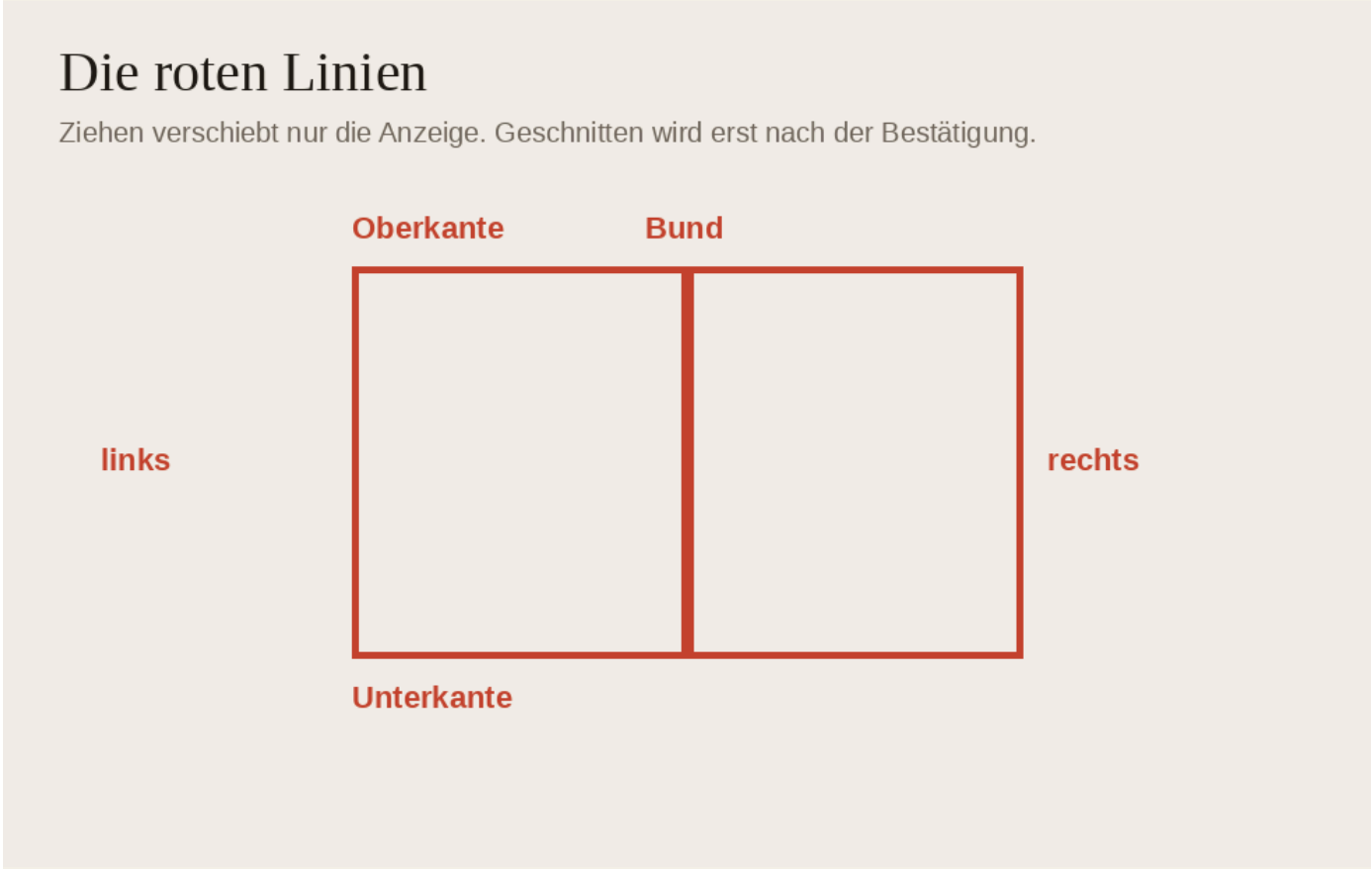
Der Bogen bleibt eine Seite. Nur der Rand wird gesetzt.



1→1. The sheet stays one page. The line only sets the margin. Use this for ordinary single-page PDFs, not 4→1.

LINES

What can be dragged



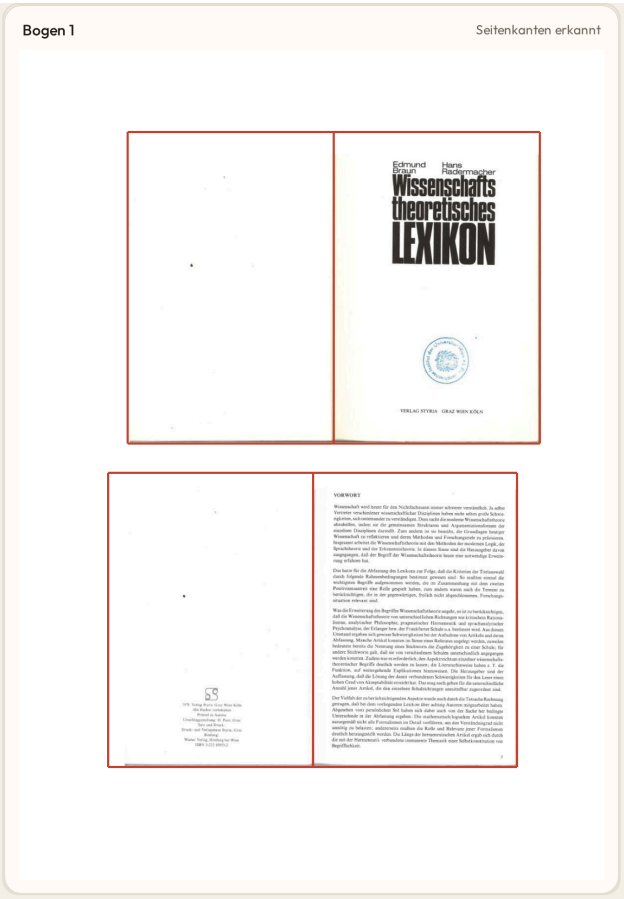
Each line has a wide handle. Drag it with the mouse button held down, or with a finger.

Left, gutter, right

Vertical handles. The gutter is the middle between two pages. 1→1 and 2 (90°)→1 have no gutter, only the outer edge.

Top, bottom

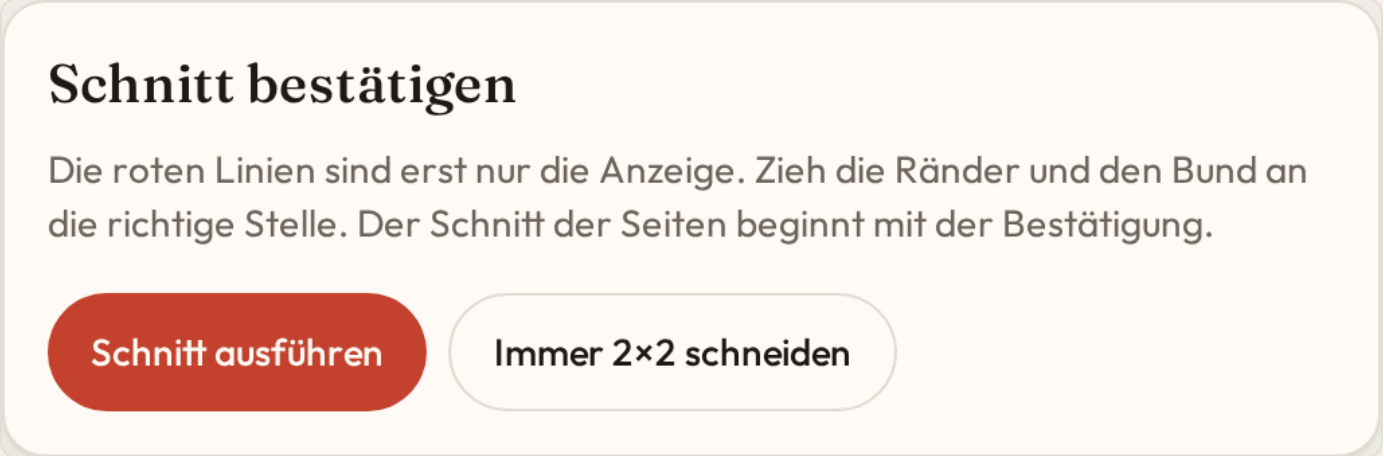
Horizontal handles. In 4→1 each row has its own edges. The rows cannot overlap.



4 → 1 on the sample sheet. The note “Seitenkanten erkannt” means the lines sit on found paper edges, not on a fixed grid.

CUT

Confirm, and only then cut



While this panel is showing, the lines are only a preview.

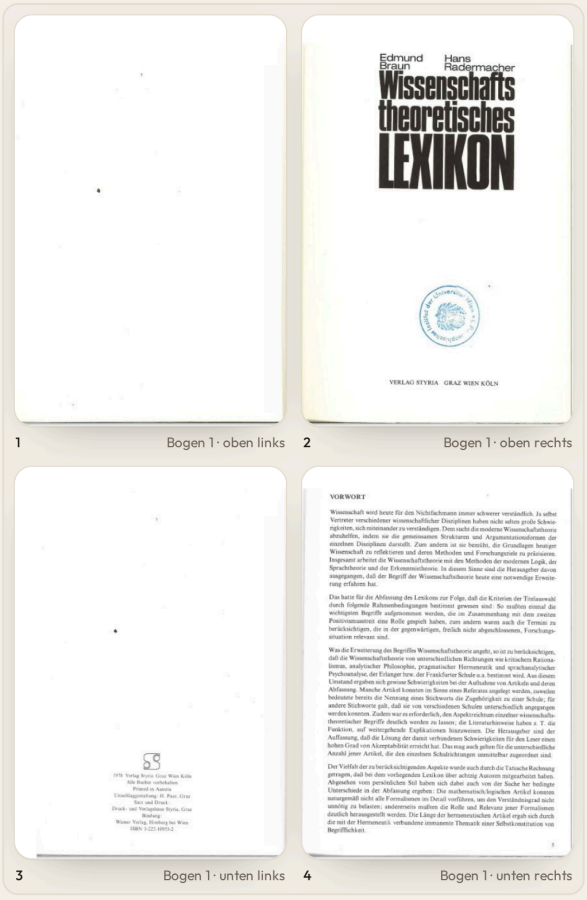
1. **Schnitt ausführen** cuts exactly on the lines that are visible.
2. The single pages appear on the right, under the sheet they came from.
3. Drag a line again afterwards and the old cut no longer counts. The confirmation panel comes back. Confirm again.
4. **Immer 2×2 schneiden** exists only for 4→1, before the cut. It ignores the found edges and divides the content into four equal fields. Useful when the scan is too faint for an edge.

Notes under the sheet

TEXT ON SCREEN	MEANING
Seitenkanten erkannt	A long, thin paper edge was found.
Schnitt am weißen Bund	No clear line, but a light gap between the pages.
Gleichmäßiger Schnitt	Neither an edge nor a gap. The area is split down the middle.
Eine Seite	Mode 1→1. There is only the outer margin.

RESULT

The single pages



1 Bogen 1 · oben links
2 Bogen 1 · oben rechts
3 Bogen 1 · unten links
4 Bogen 1 · unten rechts

After confirmation. The number is the order in the ZIP. These are the first four pages of the sample sheet.



Both save the same file. The name is the source name plus `-einzelseiten.zip`.

In the browser a pop-up may open briefly and say the ZIP is being saved. Close that tab afterwards. If the browser blocks the window, allow pop-ups and press the button again. The desktop program does not do this.

FILES

What is in the ZIP

One PDF per field, in sheet order. The number at the front runs on.

LAYOUT	EXAMPLE FOR SHEET 1

4→1	`01-bogen1-oben-links.pdf`
	`02-bogen1-oben-rechts.pdf`
	`03-bogen1-unten-links.pdf`
	`04-bogen1-unten-rechts.pdf`

2→1	`01-bogen1-links.pdf` `02-bogen1-rechts.pdf`
2 (90°)→1	`01-bogen1-oben.pdf` `02-bogen1-unten.pdf`
1→1	`01-bogen1-ganze-seite.pdf`

Sheet 2 continues the count, so 05, 06, and so on. An empty field still becomes a PDF, so the sheet count stays right.

An open book inside a photo. If a field itself looks like an open book, that spread stays in one PDF. The fields of the sheet are separated, not the two book pages inside a photograph.

How the edge is found

1. The sheet is turned into gray. Type is dark, paper is light.
2. The search looks for a long, thin edge with white above or below it. Lines of text are too dense and are left out.
3. In 4→1, two lower edges separate the rows. The gutter is the vertical edge in the middle.
4. If the left outer edge is missing, the width of the right page is mirrored to the left.
5. The white gap between the pages stays outside the cut.

There is no text recognition. Slanted words, page numbers, and stamps are not read.

IF SOMETHING STICKS

The usual cases

Windows will not open the file

The program is not signed. **More info**, then **Run anyway**. The same step applies to `Schnittkante.exe` and to the installer.

The lines cut through the text

Drag the handle until the red line sits on the paper edge or in the white gap. Then press **Schnitt ausführen** again.

An ordinary PDF is cut into four

First choose **1→1** at the top. Then open the PDF again. 4→1 is only for sheets that hold four pages, and the choice applies only to the next opening.

The scan is too faint

For 4→1, before the cut, use **Immer 2×2 schneiden**. Or set the lines by hand.

The AppImage does not start

Open the file properties and allow execution. Some computers also need `chmod +x`.

The browser does not save the ZIP

Allow pop-ups for the page. Then press the red button or the underlined link **ZIP-Datei herunterladen** again. Both deliver the same file.

Where the files are

Source and programs are at `https://github.com/joergre/Schnittkante`. On Windows use `Schnittkante-Setup.exe` if a Start menu entry is wanted, otherwise `Schnittkante.exe`. On Linux use the `.deb` for Ubuntu, Mint, and Debian, otherwise the AppImage. In the browser, open your server address and install it as an app. After that the order is always the same: layout first, then the PDF, then the lines, then the cut, then the ZIP.